



|          | START                                                                                            | STOP                                                                                                                                     | CONTINUE                                                                                                                      | REDUCE                                                                                                                                    |
|----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Facebook | Making meaningful posts                                                                          | Forwarding links mindlessly                                                                                                              | Sharing content appropriate to the platform                                                                                   | The sarcasm, cynicism unless it really is witty                                                                                           |
|          | Choosing privacy settings for the photos that you upload                                         | Updating too regularly. You don't want to look too attention seeking                                                                     | Commenting on other people's posts every now and then                                                                         | Posting for the sake of posting something                                                                                                 |
|          | Updating even your professional details on Facebook. Many recruitment firms lurk around          | Sharing meaningless baby videos. No one really wants to see those. But once in a while a funny video will be appreciated by your friends | Changing your profile pic every now and then. But choose carefully. You don't want one in which you've got a beer mug in hand | Posting updates one after another. Even if you have a lot to say, it's good to pace yourself. Give people time to digest what you've said |
| Twitter  | Building a speciality area. This creates an identity for yourself.                               | "Cribbing endlessly. You never know who is looking, and what conclusion are being drawn                                                  | A few personal posts now and then. This doesn't mean stuff like "had 2 spoons of sugar in my tea this morning"                | Re-tweeting too much of stuff                                                                                                             |
|          | Being a little witty. It's a little difficult to do in 140 characters, but it will set you apart | Bad-mouthing people. This is a very close knit circle, and word spreads quickly                                                          | Responding to questions, comments, replies. People like to be responded to                                                    | Pushing links too much, no matter how great the stuff your sharing. Think original content                                                |
|          | Sticking to a topic of interest                                                                  | Using bad grammar. Post simple sentences but make them read correctly                                                                    | Creating privacy lists on Facebook and Follower lists on twitter.                                                             | The flirting please. Twitter is very picky about that sort of thing                                                                       |
| LinkedIn | A LinkedIn profile if you haven't started one already                                            | Changing your profile picture too frequently                                                                                             | Valuing people's time – reach out, don't spam                                                                                 | Frivolous posts                                                                                                                           |
|          | Joining relevant groups. But selectively.                                                        | Posting your twitter feed into LinkedIn                                                                                                  | Updating your profile regularly                                                                                               | Using too many apps on your profile page                                                                                                  |
| General  | Posting in the platform that gives you most response and that you're comfortable with            | Using foul language on some networks. Understand the culture first.                                                                      | Using a common username across all networks, unless you <i>want</i> a separate identity                                       | Posting things you're not really sure about. Opinions are fine                                                                            |

have found their own interesting ways of using this platform. Though most of what goes on in the twitterverse is utter rot generated by people with loads of time on their hands, if you make the right follow choices, you can use it to your advantage in many ways. The open nature of the platform allows you to connect with people, make contacts, get jobs, and even keep up with news specific to your interests. *[Check out the boxes for real life examples]*

So how do you use Twitter effectively? It's best if you provide a personal touch to your posts, but keep your posts restricted to a certain subject area. Your bio is very important and in keeping with the infamous twitter 140 character credo, this too has a restricted count. Keep it specific and quirky all at once. Difficult? Not really. Use a random word generator, and throw in some articulates like enthusiast, dreamer, etc., and you should be through. Of course we're kidding, but you get the picture.

Perhaps the most important advice anyone can give you is to jump in with both feet. Don't stand on the periphery and observe, because if you do, that's all you'll ever end up doing. To get what is known as critical mass, you need to up the interactivity for the initial period. If your Twitter

account is languishing revive it with full gusto rather than a half-hearted attempt.

Though Twitter is a mass market tool (unlike niche ones we'll talk about later), it is a close knit community of recognisable names (called handles). The twitterati, as they're called, monitor each other's posts with a keen eye and keep interacting on a regular basis in the offline world as well through tweet ups. Once you gain street credits in the Twitter world, more and more people will start following you. Having more followers means you get a ready sounding board for any idea you may want to test out first.

Yes, there's a lot of clannish snobbery that goes on too, but hey isn't that just an honest reflection of the real world?

To conclude, what Twitter can give you is succinctly put forth in the words of a twitter enthusiast, who for reasons easily understandable, wanted to not be associated with the quote, "I now have a wide circle of acquaintances, a smaller set of people I like, and a much smaller group of people who are friends".

## LinkedIn

For the most part, LinkedIn is all about serious business. The norms and culture for

this network are pretty set. People are here to connect, so you're not asking for a backdoor entry into their space. They usually state the subject areas for which they would like to connect – Job Prospects, Business interests, etc. There are also people who call themselves LIONs or LinkedIn Open Networkers. These guys will not reject your add request.

Normally when you send requests, LinkedIn asks you to state the way in which you know them – Friend, Colleague or Classmate etc. You can choose the Friend option, but beware – if you don't add a good enough note accompanying your request, they might click on "don't know this person". If a good enough number of people click that for you, your ability to add more people gets restricted. Recruiters use this social networking platform extensively, so be detailed and create your profile carefully highlighting whatever projects you have undertaken in every job role.

## Our take

Twitter enthusiasts may not want to admit it, but this world is just a slightly sophisticated version of the good old a/s/l chat room days. Except here there is anonymity by choice and one has to be a little more witty than asking an outright a/s/l to make a lasting connection.